MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including recent hands-on work owning CI/CD pipelines and building test infrastructure for three product teams. Experienced with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes namespace-level environments, and infrastructure automation through a personal k3s and GitOps homelab. Improved pipeline speed and test reliability, and created documentation used in team onboarding. Transitioning toward DevOps and platform engineering, with personal projects provisioning a Hetzner VPS using Terraform and learning AWS EC2 and S3 fundamentals.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic), Argo CD, Git
Containers & Platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level work), k3s, Linux
Monitoring & Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, test metrics dashboards
Programming & Data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 fundamentals

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data, and built a Python/GitLab API workflow to collect CI test results for Grafana dashboards.
- Wrote an internal guide to how CI works, now used in onboarding. Mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress, and TLS certificates with cert-manager.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented per-merge-request environments deployed from GitLab CI using Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster, with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against each environment; configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results through the GitLab API into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; helped teams reduce the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*
ISTQB Foundation Level *2019*
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) *In progress; exam scheduled for January 2027*

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)